

Richa Latta

🏠 San Francisco Bay Area
📞 (714) 270-9639
✉️ richa.latta@gmail.com

Results-driven **Engineering Leader** with over **15 years of experience** in **product quality, technical program management, and cross-functional leadership**. Proven ability to **align engineering, product, and operations teams** to deliver large-scale, high-impact initiatives. Skilled in **strategic planning, KPI-driven decision-making, and execution** to drive operational excellence. Passionate about **scaling teams, and leading innovative initiatives** that enhance product reliability and customer experience.

Core Competencies

- Quality Assurance Leadership & Program Management
 - Process Optimization & Continuous Improvement
 - Cross-Functional Team Leadership
 - Automation Frameworks & CI/CD Implementation
 - KPI Definition & Data-Driven Decision Making
 - Agile & Scaled Agile (SAFe) Methodologies
-

Experience

February 2023 - Present

Associate Director of Engineering - Quality & Program Management / SiriusXM-Pandora, Oakland

- **Established and tracked KPIs**, leveraging data-driven insights to guide strategic decision-making and enhance service quality.
- **Led executive quality reviews**, presenting performance metrics and quality improvements to senior leadership.
- **Directed a team of 50 engineers and 3 managers**, overseeing project execution, optimizing workflows to enhance product quality.
- **Implemented structured program management frameworks**, enabling TPMs to drive cross-functional coordination, risk mitigation, & timely project delivery.
- Work closely with program managers, and operations teams to define quality goals and establish clear services standards.

February 2021- February 2023

Sr. Manager Engineering - Quality & Program Management / SiriusXM-Pandora, Oakland

- **Led a team of 20 quality engineers and 2 managers**, driving performance and contract testing initiatives to enhance system reliability.
- Developed and implemented test strategies to ensure the quality and reliability of standalone services such as Ads, search, and recommendations.
- **Established cross-functional collaboration frameworks**, enhancing resource utilization and project efficiency.
- **Developed program roadmaps and risk assessment strategies**, ensuring smooth execution of high-impact initiatives.
- **Drove automation and CI/CD adoption**, leading to a **30% reduction in manual testing efforts** and **20% faster release cycles**.

October 2018 – February 2021

Manager Quality Engineering / SiriusXM-Pandora, Oakland

- Managed a team of 12 quality engineers mainly focusing on Ads testing on client and playback services to optimize performance, reliability, and user experience.
- Collaborate closely with development, product management, and operations teams to define quality goals and establish clear quality assurance standards.
- Implemented best practices for test automation, resulting in a **15% increase in test coverage** and a **10% reduction in testing cycle time**.
- **Bi-weekly metrics presentation to leadership** to reassess automation coverage goals.

June 2015 – October 2018

Senior QA Engineer / Pandora Media Inc, Oakland

- Led the implementation of Selenium WebDriver automation using the Page Object model and set up a custom Jenkins pipeline for continuous integration.
- Streamlined the quality engineering process and created standard tools that reduced touch time by 30%.
- Developed and optimized end-to-end automated testing suites, reducing manual testing efforts by 40%, accelerating release cycles by 30%, and improving overall test coverage.
- Collaborated with cross-functional teams to design and implement performance testing strategies, ensuring services met scalability and reliability benchmarks

July 2012 – June 2015

QA Manager / Balluun Inc, Foster City

- Served as cross functional manager in quality assurance, program manager, customer support.
- Oversaw defining and resolving of critical technical and program issues and ensured QA support to the development team.
- Lead QA and Automation efforts across all Balluun products. Responsible for setting up Automation framework with Selenium using Java.

November 2011 – July 2012

QA Engineer / McAfee Inc, Santa Clara

December 2009 – November 2010

QA Engineer / Sony PlayStation, Foster City

October 2007 – September 2009

Project Engineer / Wipro Technologies, Bangalore

Education

December 2007

Bachelors of Engineering / Kurukshetra University, India

Major: Computer Science